

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 41)

Page 202 - General Prose and Edinburgh Men

Q1. The rise of the modern review and magazine gave great encouragement to what form of writing?

- A. The epic poem
- B. Essay-writing
- C. The dramatic monologue
- D. The three-volume novel

Answer: B

Q2. The literature of criticism divided critics of the age into which two groups?

- A. The conservative/classical and the radical/romantic
- B. The optimists and the pessimists
- C. The realists and the naturalists
- D. The political and the philosophical

Answer: A

Q3. How is the prose of the eighteenth century (like that of Addison and Goldsmith) characterized?

- A. It lacked lucidity and charm
- B. It had strong passion and deep feeling
- C. It had lucidity, grace, and charm, but lacked variety, warmth, and color
- D. It was highly complex and deeply structural

Answer: C

Q4. What did the romantic movement bring to prose?

- A. A return to strict classical rules
- B. A complete lack of emotion
- C. Strong passion, deep feeling, and a love of variety, warmth, and color
- D. A purely scientific and analytical approach

Answer: C

Q5. The new movement in prose was partly connected with a revival of interest in which authors?

- A. The early Augustan authors
- B. The pre-Augustan authors
- C. The contemporary French authors
- D. The ancient Roman authors

Answer: B

Q6. The prose writers of this era are grouped into three categories. Which is NOT one of these?

- A. The Edinburgh men
- B. The London men
- C. The Lake District men
- D. Miscellaneous writers falling under neither head

Answer: C

Q7. Who was called by his admirers the 'Archcritic' and by his victims 'Judge Jeffrey'?

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- A. Francis Jeffrey
- B. Sydney Smith
- C. John Wilson
- D. John Gibson Lockhart

Answer: A

Q8. To which periodical did Francis Jeffrey contribute some 200 articles?

- A. The Quarterly
- B. Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine
- C. The Edinburgh Review
- D. The London Magazine

Answer: C

Q9. The nickname 'Judge Jeffrey' references a notorious 'bloody judge' of which century?

- A. The sixteenth century
- B. The seventeenth century
- C. The eighteenth century
- D. The nineteenth century

Answer: B

Q10. How is Francis Jeffrey's critical stance described?

- A. Radically romantic
- B. As representing the conservative side in criticism
- C. As completely rejecting all Augustan traditions
- D. As heavily favoring the new romantic poets

Answer: B

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Page 203 - Jeffrey, Smith, and Wilson

Q1. Which of the following is described as a limitation of Francis Jeffrey's criticism today?

- A. He had too much sympathy for the romantics
- B. He lacked breadth of sympathy and flexibility of judgment
- C. He focused too much on subject-matter and neglected form
- D. He was too deeply concerned with the large human aspects of literature

Answer: B

Q2. Who was an exceedingly clever clergyman better known for his witticisms than his literature?

- A. Francis Jeffrey
- B. John Wilson
- C. Sydney Smith
- D. Thomas De Quincey

Answer: C

Q3. What is the title of Sydney Smith's brilliant satire on the Irish question (1807)?

- A. Noctes Ambrosianae
- B. Peter Plymley's Letters
- C. Murder considered as one of the Fine Arts
- D. The Bride's Tragedy

Answer: B

Q4. Why are Sydney Smith's writings now little read?

- A. They are too complex to understand
- B. They deal mostly with dead abuses and forgotten controversies
- C. They are written in difficult Latin
- D. They lack humor and are too serious

Answer: B

Q5. Which 'Blackwood's man' was famous under the pen-name of Christopher North?

- A. Thomas De Quincey
- B. John Gibson Lockhart
- C. John Wilson
- D. Sydney Smith

Answer: C

Q6. Which position did John Wilson hold while also being a devotee of the prize ring?

- A. Editor of the Edinburgh Review
- B. Professor of Moral Philosophy in the University of Edinburgh
- C. Prime Minister
- D. Poet Laureate

Answer: B

Q7. What is considered John Wilson's best work?

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- A. Noctes Ambrosianae
- B. Peter Plymley's Letters
- C. Confessions of an English Opium Eater
- D. The English Mail Coach

Answer: A

Q8. In what format are the 'Noctes Ambrosianae' written?

- A. Formal essays
- B. Dialogues
- C. Epic poetry
- D. Tragic drama

Answer: B

Q9. What makes 'Noctes Ambrosianae' difficult for the southern reader to appreciate today?

- A. Their heavy use of Latin
- B. Their broad Scotch language and largely local/temporary interest
- C. Their lack of humor and dash
- D. Their focus on deep theological arguments

Answer: B

Q10. Who was a personal friend of Wilson, wrote for the London Magazine, and is considered a far greater figure in literature?

- A. Sydney Smith
- B. Thomas De Quincey
- C. Charles Lamb
- D. Leigh Hunt

Answer: B

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Page 204 - De Quincey and Lockhart

Q1. Thomas De Quincey is considered one of our chief masters of what kind of prose?

- A. Augustan rational prose
- B. Romantic impassioned prose
- C. Scientific descriptive prose
- D. Neoclassical satire

Answer: B

Q2. Which of the following is NOT listed as a defect in De Quincey's writing?

- A. A habit of abusing his extraordinary learning
- B. Sinking into obscurity and pedantry
- C. Lacking any sense of humor
- D. Indulging in huge unwieldy digressions

Answer: C

Q3. In which work did De Quincey achieve remarkable success combining grim humor with the horrible?

- A. The English Mail Coach
- B. Dream Fugue
- C. Murder considered as one of the Fine Arts
- D. Joan of Arc

Answer: C

Q4. By what work will Thomas De Quincey always be best remembered?

- A. Confessions of an English Opium Eater
- B. Life of Scott
- C. The English Comic Writers
- D. Spanish Ballads

Answer: A

Q5. Which writer acts as a connecting link between Edinburgh and London, editing the Quarterly from 1826?

- A. Thomas De Quincey
- B. John Gibson Lockhart
- C. Charles Lamb
- D. William Hazlitt

Answer: B

Q6. Who wrote the powerful study of a good man's sin and remorse in the novel 'Adam Blair'?

- A. John Wilson
- B. Thomas De Quincey
- C. John Gibson Lockhart
- D. Charles Lamb

Answer: C

Q7. What is Lockhart's principal title to fame?

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- A. His Life of Burns
- B. His Spanish Ballads
- C. His magnificent Life of Scott
- D. His novel Adam Blair

Answer: C

Q8. Lockhart was romantic with Scott and sympathized with Wordsworth, but how did he treat the younger generation (Shelley, Keats, Tennyson)?

- A. With great admiration
- B. With indifference
- C. With hostility
- D. By imitating their style

Answer: C

Q9. Lockhart is known to have written an almost equally savage criticism of whose 1833 volume in the Quarterly?

- A. John Keats
- B. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- C. Lord Byron
- D. Alfred Tennyson

Answer: D

Q10. Whose daughter did John Gibson Lockhart marry in 1820?

- A. William Wordsworth's
- B. Sir Walter Scott's
- C. Francis Jeffrey's
- D. John Wilson's

Answer: B

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Page 205 - Lockhart and Charles Lamb

Q1. What nickname was given to John Gibson Lockhart due to his special gift of sarcasm used with deadly effect?

- A. The Serpent
- B. The Scorpion
- C. Judge Jeffrey
- D. The Archcritic

Answer: B

Q2. Who is described as 'first among these in our affections' when discussing the London men?

- A. William Hazlitt
- B. Leigh Hunt
- C. Charles Lamb
- D. Thomas De Quincey

Answer: C

Q3. According to Southey, whose memory 'will retain its fragrance as long as the best spice expended on the Pharaohs'?

- A. Charles Lamb
- B. John Keats
- C. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- D. William Wordsworth

Answer: A

Q4. What is the most widely-known portion of Charles Lamb's work?

- A. Tales from Shakespeare
- B. John Woodvil
- C. Essays of Elia
- D. Specimens of English Dramatic Poets

Answer: C

Q5. In his essays, Charles Lamb is compared to which other great egotist writer?

- A. Francis Bacon
- B. Michel de Montaigne
- C. Samuel Johnson
- D. Thomas Browne

Answer: B

Q6. How is Charles Lamb's unique blending of tenderness and quaint fancies described?

- A. Swiftian
- B. Lambish
- C. Byronic
- D. Shakespearian

Answer: B

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Q7. Lamb's romanticism was largely retrospective and nourished itself on the literature of which age?

- A. The Augustan age
- B. The pre-Augustan age (Elizabethan and 17th century)
- C. The Middle Ages
- D. The Romantic revival in Germany

Answer: B

Q8. Which work by Lamb did much to spread the knowledge of older English playwrights?

- A. John Woodvil
- B. Tales from Shakespeare
- C. Essays of Elia
- D. Specimens of English Dramatic Poets

Answer: D

Q9. Lamb's style is flavored by constant contact with his favorite writers. Which of the following is NOT one of them?

- A. Burton
- B. Fuller
- C. Sir Thomas Browne
- D. Alexander Pope

Answer: D

Q10. Lamb whimsically said that he wrote neither for the present nor for the future, but for:

- A. Antiquity
- B. The romantics
- C. Children
- D. Money

Answer: A

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Page 206 - William Hazlitt, Leigh Hunt, and Cobbett

Q1. William Hazlitt is a capital illustration of how the popularity of magazines turned literature into the channels of:

- A. Novel-writing
- B. Epic poetry
- C. Journalism
- D. Scientific treatises

Answer: C

Q2. Hazlitt's fine catholicity enabled him to do justice to the romantic school without being unjust to which other group?

- A. The pre-Raphaelites
- B. The Augustans
- C. The Metaphysicals
- D. The Victorians

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following is NOT one of Hazlitt's collections of lectures or essays?

- A. Characters of Shakespeare's Plays
- B. The English Poets
- C. The Dramatic Literature of the Age of Elizabeth
- D. Specimens of English Dramatic Poets

Answer: D

Q4. Because of his insight, discrimination, and sureness of taste and touch, what has Hazlitt been called?

- A. The Scorpion
- B. Judge Jeffrey
- C. The critic's critic
- D. The Archcritic

Answer: C

Q5. What limitation is noted about Hazlitt's criticism?

- A. It is too deeply focused on historical backgrounds
- B. It makes no attempt to connect the author with the life and spirit of his age
- C. It heavily relies on Latin and Greek sources
- D. It is too romantic and rejects all classical literature

Answer: B

Q6. Leigh Hunt is included among the periodical prose writers, but what did he lack that made his books largely fragmentary?

- A. The power of sustained effort
- B. Basic literacy skills
- C. Knowledge of pre-Augustan writers
- D. Connections with magazine publishers

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Answer: A

Q7. What quality does Leigh Hunt's genius possess, according to the text?

- A. A heavy, moralistic tone
- B. A butterfly quality
- C. A scorpion-like sarcasm
- D. A deep philosophical rigor

Answer: B

Q8. Which book of Leigh Hunt's did Thomas Carlyle call 'a pious, ingenious, altogether human and worthy book'?

- A. Story of Rimini
- B. The English Comic Writers
- C. His Autobiography
- D. His essays on Keats

Answer: C

Q9. Who was the coarse, vigorous, independent political reformer, journalist, and pamphleteer mentioned at the end of the page?

- A. Charles Lamb
- B. Thomas De Quincey
- C. William Cobbett
- D. John Gibson Lockhart

Answer: C

Q10. William Cobbett stood prominently as a prose writer of the period, but how did he relate to the other sets and groups?

- A. He was the undisputed leader of the London men
- B. He was a close coadjutor of Jeffrey in Edinburgh
- C. He stood entirely apart from every set and group
- D. He was the main financial backer of Blackwood's

Answer: C